

Chapter 45-4

When the movie ended, there were behind-the-scenes clips, and in those clips Yang Shuyan transformed into a cheerful neighbor-sister type.

Liang Shi watched in amazement.

And Xu Qingzhu, who was usually quiet during movies, couldn't help but say, "She's so beautiful."

Liang Shi: "..."

"What?" Liang Shi suddenly snapped out of her movie-watching state.

Xu Qingzhu said objectively, "I didn't think so much when I saw her photos before, but she's so beautiful in the movie."

Liang Shi: "..."

The bullet comments from that day suddenly came flooding back to her mind—

"Heaven-conquering earth-conquering glamorous villain Alpha X wealthy princess glamorous white lotus¹ Omega!"

And that one image that made everyone who saw it call it absolutely perfect.

Photoshopped with no sense of incongruity.

The two people were only inches apart—cool older sister type X fishing system².

Anyone who saw it would fall into the CP³ fan pit and never climb out.

Liang Shi coughed quietly, putting away all her praise for Yang Shuyan in her heart, pretending to be nonchalant as she said, "Really? I think she's just so-so."

Xu Qingzhu was surprised, "Weren't you also watching with great interest just now?"

"That was because the plot was good." Liang Shi was stubborn: "I was immersed in the storyline."

Xu Qingzhu: "... Is that so?"

She clearly didn't believe it, raising an eyebrow and saying, "Don't tell me you don't think Yang Shuyan is beautiful?"

Liang Shi avoided her gaze that carried a hint of amusement, answering, "She's okay, ordinarily pretty. I think Sister Ying⁴ is more beautiful."

Xu Qingzhu clicked her tongue, "As expected, so everyone says Alphas repel each other, right?"

Liang Shi: "... No, she's just ordinary. Her acting is just so-so too."

Yes, not that great.

Although she seemed to be a little bit better than her current self, it was only a little bit.

Given time, she would definitely surpass Yang Shuyan.

Liang Shi used to be very laid-back in the industry. She could maintain good surface relationships with many people precisely because she was laid-back—someone who didn't fight or compete was especially precious in the entire entertainment industry.

If there was a suitable script, she'd take it; if not, she'd rest.

She never used underhanded methods to harm others.

This was the first time a burning competitive spirit had ignited in her heart.

Wasn't it just good acting?

She could do it too.

She was quite good-looking too.

Looking carefully, her features weren't inferior to Yang Shuyan's, and in some small details, she was even slightly better.

Of course, Liang Shi felt a bit guilty saying this now.

So after saying it, she coughed lightly and added with obvious defensiveness, "Really."

Xu Qingzhu glanced over lightly, her eyes seeming to say—I've already seen through everything.

She shrugged, "I didn't say it was fake either."

Then she added, "I haven't seen Sister Ying's performances, so I won't comment. But everyone has different aesthetics. In terms of looks, I still prefer Yang Shuyan's type."

Liang Shi: "...?"

"Don't you prefer..." Liang Shi's words got stuck halfway through, then she awkwardly pressed her lips together.

This seemed to be her subconscious competitive spirit at work.

From a legal standpoint, she was her wife.

So... it seemed... she did have a bit of possessiveness.

Living together day and night, many things seemed to be quietly changing without notice.

Liang Shi felt her mindset was getting a bit dangerous.

And Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow, her smile carrying a hint of teasing, "Prefer who? You?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She turned her face away, not looking at Xu Qingzhu, her tone carrying a hint of petulance, "That wouldn't be impossible either."

As soon as she said this, she heard Xu Qingzhu's quiet laugh.

Liang Shi: "...?"

Was that mockery?

What was so funny about this?

Liang Shi coughed lightly, pretending to be calm and righteous, "I'm not worse-looking than Yang Shuyan, am I? Last time when I was trending, many people said I was good-looking."

"Really?" Xu Qingzhu was surprised, "I didn't see that. I was busy watching everyone mock Chen Liuying, saying even pulling a random dog from the street would act better than her."

"But Chen Liuying acting badly doesn't mean I act badly too." Liang Shi retorted, "Besides..."

She stopped mid-sentence.

She slowly turned her head, looking at Xu Qingzhu in bewilderment, only to find Xu Qingzhu's face carrying a smile.

...

She casually grabbed a cushion and threw it over, which Xu Qingzhu caught perfectly.

Hugging the cushion, Xu Qingzhu curled up on the sofa, laughing until she shook, her head buried in the cushion, her voice muffled.

"You're insulting people." Liang Shi mumbled in complaint.

Xu Qingzhu laughed until her speech was unclear, "How did you only just realize?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She helplessly leaned back on the sofa, waiting for Xu Qingzhu to finish laughing.

Laughter seemed to be contagious.

Originally she didn't want to laugh, but hearing Xu Qingzhu laugh, she soon started laughing along too.

Footnotes: ¹ White lotus: A Chinese internet term for someone who appears pure and innocent on the surface but is actually scheming, particularly referring to female characters who act helpless to manipulate others ² Fishing system: A Chinese internet slang referring to someone who appears gentle and harmless but is actually calculating or manipulative, like "fishing" for attention or benefits ³ CP: Stands for "couple" or "character pairing," referring to fans who support romantic relationships between fictional characters or real people ⁴ Sister Ying: Refers to Zhao Ying, an actress character mentioned earlier in the story